



Don't sit on me!

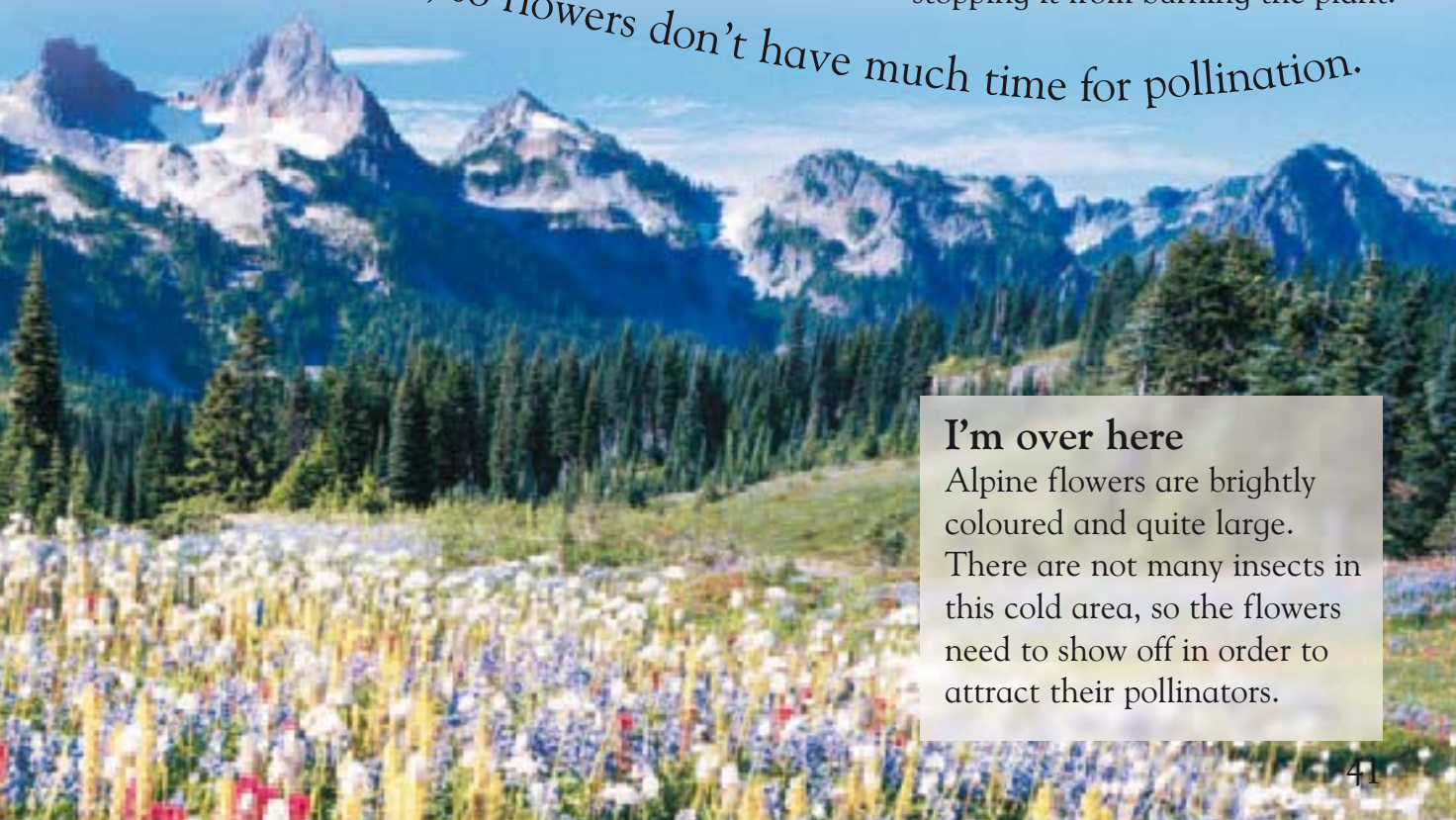
Alpine plants grow low to the ground to avoid ferocious winds. Some, called cushion plants, even grow huddled together for warmth. They look like huge pillows scattered on the ground. Up to a million plants can grow in one clump.



A bad hair day?

Saussurea plants have taken the idea of a fur coat to the extreme. The pink fluff is not its flower, but hair on the leaves. On some plants hair reflects the harsh sunlight, stopping it from burning the plant.

Springtime is short, so flowers don't have much time for pollination.



I'm over here

Alpine flowers are brightly coloured and quite large. There are not many insects in this cold area, so the flowers need to show off in order to attract their pollinators.